SPX Options Flow — Weekly Macro Briefing

Weekly Options Flow & Dealer Positioning Analysis

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▼ SHORT GAMMA

RISK: EXTREME

Composite Score: **-0.38**

SPX SPOT	NET GEX	GAMMA FLIP	DIST. TO FLIP
6,625	-2468.32B	5,970	+9.9%

CALL WALL #1	PUT WALL #1	MAX PAIN	VIX
6,625	6,625	6,690	25.72

Dealers are in SHORT GAMMA with net GEX of $-2468.32B. Spot (6,625) sits 9.9% above the gamma flip level (5,970). Composite macro score: -0.38 → Risk Level: EXTREME. Key risks: BEARISH_VOL_BUY, OPEX 1DTE, DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW, BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY.

REGIME PLAYBOOK

▲ EQUITIES
Reduce net delta, buy downside puts for protection

◆ VOLATILITY
Long VIX, buy volatility — trend moves may persist

◆ OPTIONS STRATEGY
Long straddles, buy gamma for directional exposure

◆ POSITION SIZING
Reduce 30–50% — elevated tail risk in short-gamma regime

GEX Profile — Dealer Gamma Exposure

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KEY LEVELS

STRIKE	TYPE	GEX ($M)	DIST. FROM SPOT	INTERPRETATION
6,625	Call Wall	+950529M	+0.0%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,750	Call Wall	+113535M	+1.9%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,700	Call Wall	+75445M	+1.1%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,625	Put Wall	-2016558M	+0.0%	Support / dealer delta hedge floor
6,600	Put Wall	-551700M	-0.4%	Support / dealer delta hedge floor
6,700	Put Wall	-116090M	+1.1%	Support / dealer delta hedge floor

OPEX: 2026-03-20 (1 DTE)

Net GEX Expiring	% of Total Book
$-607922M	24.6%

Expiry Roll-Off & Delta Exposure

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GEX BY EXPIRY

DEX PROFILE

OPEX-SPECIFIC GEX (2026-03-20)

> **Max Pain:** 6,690 — Market tends to gravitate toward max-pain strike in the final trading sessions before OPEX as dealers neutralise hedges.

Flow Analytics — Vanna, Charm & Put Skew

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VANNA & CHARM EXPOSURE

Vanna: dDelta/dSigma — when vol changes, dealers re-hedge delta mechanically. Positive vanna = vol compression drives equity buying.
Charm: dDelta/dT — daily delta decay creates intraday mechanical flows even without price movement. Strongest near OPEX.

PUT/CALL OI RATIO

Put/Call Ratio: Values above 1.5 signal heavy defensive hedging by institutions. Put walls represent strikes where dealer short put hedging provides natural support on selloffs.

SIGNAL DETAIL

Gamma Regime

BEARISH_VOL_BUY

-1.00

STRONG

Net GEX = $-2468.32B → dealers are SHORT GAMMA. Spot is 9.9% above gamma flip at 5,970.

- Equities: trending moves more likely, reduce net delta exposure
- Vol: VIX spikes may persist — avoid short vol
- Options: long gamma / straddles for directional flexibility

Flip Proximity

ABOVE FLIP: STABLE

+0.20

WEAK

Spot (6,625) is 9.9% above gamma flip (5,970). Dealer support likely on dips toward flip.

- Watch 5,970 as key inflection — sustained close above = regime shift
- Volatility clustering risk increases near flip

OPEX Countdown

OPEX 1DTE

-0.70

STRONG

OPEX in 1 DTE (CRITICAL urgency). $-607922M net GEX expiring = 24.6% of total book. Pin behaviour likely near OPEX strikes.

- Pin risk: market may gravitate to max-pain strike ±0.5% as OPEX approaches
- Post-OPEX: expect vol reset once large GEX concentration expires
- Book impact: 24.6% of dealer delta hedging unwind at OPEX

Vanna Flow

VOL_FALL_BID

+1.00

STRONG

Vanna exposure = $+133527M. Vol compression → mechanical equity bid via delta re-hedging. VIX 1d change: +0.63 (rising) — diverging with vanna signal.

- Vol decline → dealer delta re-hedging creates systematic equity buying
- Watch VIX 1d direction as leading indicator of vanna flow direction
- Strong positive vanna + falling VIX = powerful mechanical tailwind

Charm Flow

DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW

-1.00

STRONG

Charm exposure = $-14184823M/day. DTE=0: charm acceleration is sharp near expiry. Negative charm = net delta drain as time passes.

- Charm creates mechanical daily delta flows even with no price movement
- Near OPEX, charm accelerates and can distort intraday price action

Put/Call Skew

BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY

-0.80

STRONG

Put/Call GEX ratio = 2.49. Heavy put protection in dealer books — bearish defensive positioning. Put wall at 6,625 (+0.0% from spot).

- High put skew: dealers long delta hedge → can provide natural support near put walls
- Hedging demand exceeds upside speculation — institutional risk-off signal

Multi-Instrument Positioning

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CROSS-ASSET GEX SUMMARY

INSTRUMENT	SPOT	NET GEX ($B)	REGIME	FLIP LEVEL	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL	PUT WALL
SPX — S&P 500 Index	6,624.70	-2468.32B	SHORT GAMMA	5,970	+9.9%	6,625	6,625
SPY — SPDR S&P 500 ETF	661.43	+189.39B	LONG GAMMA	661	+0.1%	662	640
QQQ — Invesco QQQ ETF	594.90	+4595.83B	LONG GAMMA	594	+0.1%	595	594
IWM — iShares Russell 2000 ETF	246.02	+0.52B	LONG GAMMA	246	-0.0%	247	245

⚠ REGIME DIVERGENCE DETECTED — Cross-instrument positioning is mixed. Review individual instrument signals. Example: SPX long-gamma while IWM short-gamma = potential small-cap risk-off signal diverging from large-cap stability.

> Cross-instrument divergences often precede sector rotations. When SPX is long-gamma but IWM is short-gamma, institutional flow is concentrated in mega-cap names with less protection in small caps. When QQQ gamma diverges from SPX, watch for tech-driven directional moves.